Week 5

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Joseph Wilkes, PhD-EE

September 2026

Questions from Last Week

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This week

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- General Discussion
- Class Presents their projects

The Dunning-Kruger Curve: Why Learning AI Feels Like Going Backwards

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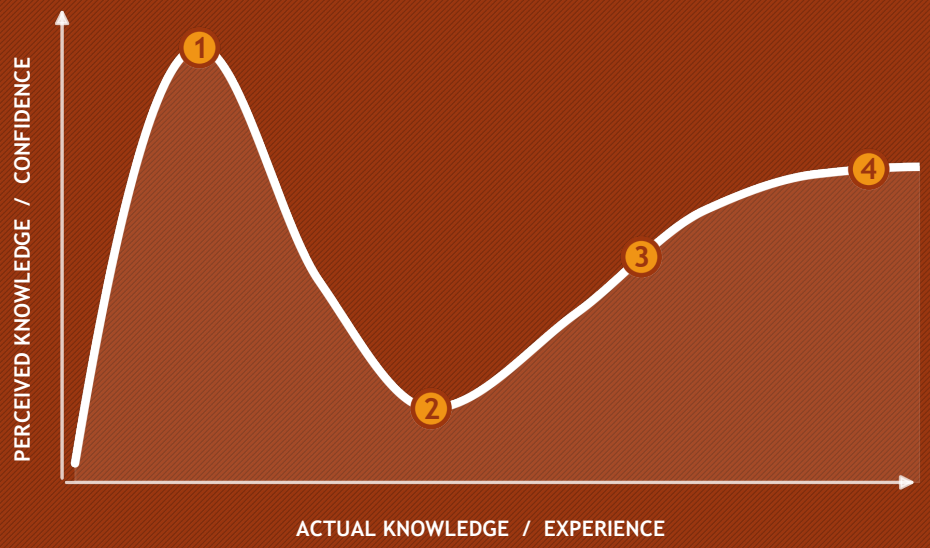

1. **Peak of "Mount Stupid"**
   A little knowledge. You cannot yet see how complex the subject is, so confidence spikes.

2. **Valley of Despair**
   You uncover an ocean of what you do not know. Confidence collapses — it feels like you know less than before.

3. **Slope of Enlightenment**
   You push through the doubt, connect the dots, and build a realistic foundation.

4. **Plateau of Sustainability**
   Real expertise. You know what you are good at — and you know your limits.

Stage 2 is **Conscious Incompetence**; stages 3-4 are **Conscious Competence**. The valley means you are learning, not failing.

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INFOAGE SCIENCE AND HISTORY MUSEUMS

The Dunning-Kruger Curve: Why Learning AI Feels Like Going Backwards
Where Are You on this Curve?
Did We meet our Goal?

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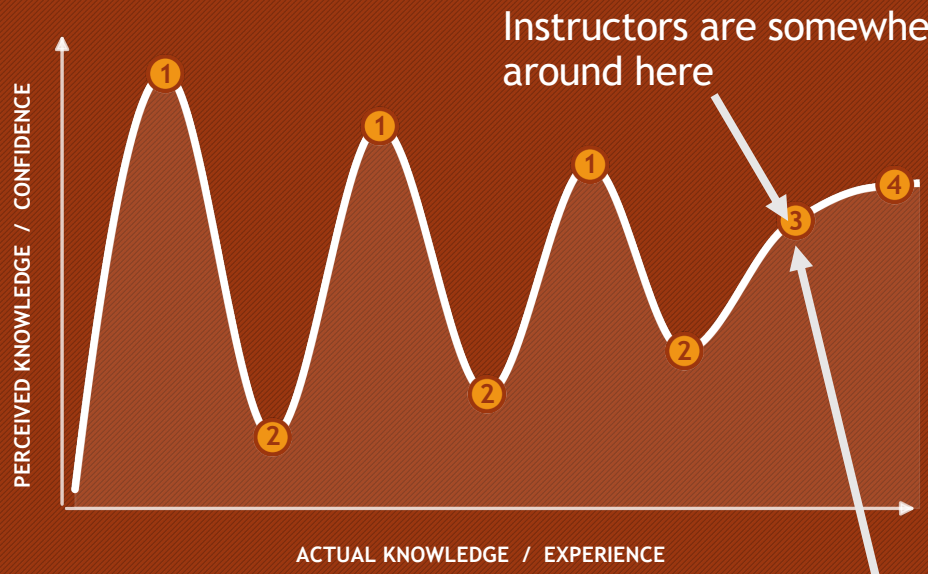

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The Goal of this class is to get you there,
without the ups and downs, the Instructors went through

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INFOAGE SCIENCE AND HISTORY MUSEUMS

Workplace Staffing

- When type writers were invented, typists were men
  - At some point the jobs evolved to being staffed by women
- When computer were first programmed, programmers were woman
  - At some point the jobs evolved to being staffed by men
- A recent article in the New York Times discussed what will happened with AI
  - https://www.nytimes.com/2026/07/31/magazine/american-women-workforce.html
  - The article is controversial but worth discussing

An Excerpt from the Article

When I asked Roos whether the gender dynamic might reverse again as artificial intelligence bleeds computer programming of status, she stipulated that she was not an expert on A.I. But if the technology causes the tech industry to divide into more and less skilled positions — say, a mix of highly paid software architects and low-paid programmers who clean up after robot coders — "then I still think that's what will happen," she said. "Those are the jobs that men will be wanting to be in charge of, and the lower-level positions would then feminize."

And, she added, the shift would not necessarily be limited to software engineering. She worries that if A.I. accelerates the sorting of lawyers, journalists, architects and advertising copywriters into low-status robot-babysitters and high-status partners and grand strategists, women will end up on the wrong end of the split, absent some intervention from government or elsewhere. "It would be history repeating itself," she said.

Source images for illustration above: George Marks/Getty Images; H. Armstrong Roberts/ClassicStock, via Getty Images; Sigrid Olsson/PhotoAlto, via Getty Images.

Noam Scheiber is a Times reporter covering white-collar workers, focusing on issues such as pay, artificial intelligence, unemployment and economic mobility.

Discussion Question

- If “junior programmers” or less skilled programmers are assigned the job of cleaning up the AI slop
- How do they improve their programming skills?
- Where do we get the Architects to design the systems?

https://www.cnbc.com/2026/07/01/employers-who-laid-off-workers-for-ai-are-reversing-their-decisions.html

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Students Present Their Projects and What They Have Learned

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ESP32 & EMBEDDED WORKFLOWS

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  https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5DG0-_lseR4

- AI-Driven ESP32 Workflow (Spec → Code → Test) using Claude Code — YouTube

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- ESP32 Sensor Monitor (local device)

  http://192.168.201.112/

CLAUDE CODE — DOCS & SETUP

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- **Claude Code overview — Claude Code Docs**

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- **anthropics/claude-code — GitHub repository**

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- **System Prompts — Claude API Docs**

  https://platform.claude.com/docs/en/release-notes/system-prompts

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- Get started with Docker containers on WSL — Microsoft Learn
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